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- **Compiler**

- Uses mathematical models - Abstract ones.
- Generates machine code.
- Parts
 - Syntax analyzer
 - Semantic analyzer
 - Lexical analyzer

- **Basics of English**

- Characters - Fundamental blocks
 - Words / Strings - Combination of characters
 - Sentence - Combination of words
- We need to check for validity of strings and sentences*

- **Language**

- A certain specified set of strings of characters from alphabets (a valid 'set' of characters).
- Some rules
 - $a^0 = \Lambda$ (Null String). Similar to phi (empty) set in mathematics.
 - $a.\Lambda = a$
 - $\Lambda.\Lambda = \Lambda$
 - No multiplication. Instead concatenation (addition of strings in code). Not commutative. Order matters (unlike numerical multiplication)

- **Operators**

- Kleene Star ($*$) - Makes an infinite language
 - If I have a set like $L = [a, b]$, then L^* would be any combination of all the characters of L . $L^* = [\Lambda, a, b, aa, bb, aab, aaa, \dots]$. Basically all combination of letters. (The Λ is a combination of $a^0.b^0$)
 - Lexicographic order: Lengthwise combination in alphabetic order. The lexicographic combination of the set L will look like $[\Lambda, a, b, aa, ab, ba, bb, aaa, aab, aba, abb, baa, bab, \dots]$.
 - If we have $L = [a, b]$ and $M = [b, a]$, $L^* = M^*$.
- Plus ($+$) - Makes an infinite language without Λ .
 - If I have a set like $L = [a, b]$, then L^+ is same as L^* without Λ . So, it would be $[a, b, aa, ab, ba, bb, \dots]$.

- If the character set has empty character, it would eventually be yielded. For example, if I have $L = [\Lambda, a, b]$, $L^+ = [\Lambda, a, b, aa, ab, \dots] = L^*$.

- **Functions**

- Length function
 - Returns length of a string. Count of characters.
- Reverse function
 - Returns reversed order of the a string.
- Palindrome $[\Lambda \text{ plus all strings } X, \text{ such that } \text{Reverse}(X) = X]$.
 - $L = [a, b]$. $\text{Palindrome}(L) = [\Lambda, a, b, aa, bb, \dots]$.

Introduction to Computer Theory - Daniel I. A Cohen